To Wish on a Dandelion

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/53027071.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by ResFlower

Summary

"They moved." She looks at Catra's belly with what can only be adoration. Adora can almost imagine the little one in there. "You're already so talented, aren't you?" Adora loves this baby more than she ever thought she'd love anyone except for Catra. She can't wait to meet them.

Catra's hand grazes the side of Adora's head, and it makes her shiver. "Adora, they are supposed to be moving by now."

She shakes her head, nuzzling Catra's belly. "Shhh, positive reinforcement is important." Her hand rests on the spot the baby bumped, hoping for another. "Besides, they gave me their first high five. I'm obviously their favorite aunt. Scorpia can eat my dust."

"Well, you're the aunt they are living with, so you sure have an advantage."

"Damn right, I have the advantage." It's an odd place to be. She's painfully aware of the fact that this baby is just Catra's —it doesn't help Adora feel any less attached. She's not sure that she's able to hold back and she isn't willing to try. "And I'm going to press it."

OR

Adora's in love with her roommate who is having a baby. This is fine.

Searching for Dandelion Wine Adora POV/Accidental Pregnancy AU

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Adora is terrified when she hears the loud cries inside of the bathroom in her apartment. She assumes it's Catra in there—who else could it be but her roommate—but she has no idea why she's crying now. Her hand rests on the doorknob as she considers coming in.

She doesn't think Catra will welcome it. Ever since her mom died, it's like nothing Adora can do will reach her. There's no amount of pleading that will make Catra let her in. It hurts so bad—not only is she worried about Catra, but she also feels lost without her.

Sure, she still lives in the same apartment, but she slips in and out like a ghost. Adora's lucky if she catches Catra sober and willing to say more than a passing greeting before she shuts herself in again. Catra has always been one of the brightest points in Adora's life. Not being able to really connect with her in the last few months has been awful.

Catra cries even louder, a sob that sounds like it's rattling her lungs as she chokes it out and there's no more waiting. Adora's surprised to find the door unlocked. She quickly draws closer, kneeling on the ground so they can be at eye level.

She looks so miserable. Tears cling to her eyelashes and her hands are shaking as she holds them together. She stares ahead but she refuses to meet Adora's gaze.

"What happened, Cat?" Adora waits anxiously as Catra takes a shuddering breath. She doesn't answer but grabs something off the little vanity and hands it over. At first, Adora has no idea what she's holding until she takes a closer look. It's a pregnancy test. "Shit. So, you're—wow."

She's ashamed to say that the first emotion that burns through her is jealousy. She knows that Catra has been having a lot of sex—probably a lot of drunk sex with strangers if she had to guess.

Adora knows she's in love with Catra but that doesn't mean she owns her. She knows Catra is free to do whatever she wants—her

and Adora are just friends. Still, it stings that she’s willing to fuck what feels like anyone but Adora. Like it’s never occurred to her that things between them could be anything but platonic.

Adora shoves it all down as Catra’s eyes water again. "Yeah. I'm—I can't do this." The sadness just seeps out of her as she crumples forward.

"Hey, hey, hey." Adora reaches for her, pulling Catra into her arms. "It's okay. Everything will be alright."

What a mess. This is the last thing Catra needs on her plate right now. Adora rubs Catra’s arm, hoping that this isn’t another thing that’ll pull Catra deeper into her depression.

"How?" The word is a croak that stays deep in her throat, even as she holds Adora tight.

"To start, you don't have to have this baby if you don't want to," Adora tries to stay steady even with what feels like Catra crumbling in her grasp. "We can get you an appointment this week if you decide you want to terminate the pregnancy."

"Well, that's the only option, isn't it?"

Adora bites her lip. She’s not sure it would be a good idea for Catra to have a baby right now, but she doesn’t want her to not allow herself to think through the choice before her. "It's not the only option. It's an important option and if it's right for you I'll support you." Adora is being too transparent right now—her voice trembles with all the emotion she typically holds back from Catra. "But if you want to keep it, Catra—that's okay too."

Catra barks out a laugh. "Adora, I'm a mess. I can't be a mom."

"You are a mess." Adora nods slowly. It’s undeniable and she won’t take Catra for a fool. "But you'll still be the best mom, Catra. If that's what you want. Whatever you want to do, alright?"

"What? Are we just going to shove a crib in my room?" She stares back at Adora incredulously.

She’s surprised by how taken she is with the idea, but she shoves that down. "If that's what it takes." "You don't have to decide now." Adora can’t even begin to guess how Catra is going to deal with this. "Why don't we go to the doctor and see what's going on?"

"Okay."

She takes Catra in for a minute. She looks calmer but her eyes are still red and puffy. "Do you know who the other parent might be?"

It’s none of Adora’s business but she’s dying of curiosity. Besides, depending on who that might be, Catra might want to talk to them about it. She frankly has no idea who her best friend has been seeing.

She immediately looks away, her cheeks flushed. "I'd have to do some math." She mumbles. "But I think ... I had that really bad weekend last month."

"Alright." She feels a little relieved that Catra doesn’t have a girlfriend she’s been hiding from Adora, at least. "Is there anything I can do for you right now?"

"I think I need a minute alone." Catra smiles at Adora, and she remembers that they’re pretty close together right now. "And maybe a chance to pull my pants up."

She glances down and realizes that Catra indeed was sitting on the toilet half naked. Adora scrambles away as quick as she can. "Right! Of course." She pauses once she gets to the bathroom door. "I'm going to order your favorite from the Thai place around the corner, okay?"

Catra gives her a shy, almost sweet smile and nods. Adora feels some relief as she closes the door behind her. She hopes that

maybe they can talk over noodles and things won't feel as tense as they have.

Going to the doctor with Catra feels like the right thing to do, but she can't deny she feels awkward as hell. She feels herself zoning in and out as the doctor speaks to Catra in soothing tones. Catra at least seems to be paying attention, her face serious as she nods occasionally.

The doctor then speaks to Adora directly. "I'm planning on angling this away from both of you while I do it. If you want to see the ultrasound I can show you, but I know some folks don't in these circumstances. It can be emotional."

She now realizes her mistake—the doctor thinks they're together. What is she supposed to say to that? *No, I'm just in love with her and I don't want her to be alone.*

"I'm a friend, I'm here to support her."

The doctor looks unconvinced, but she doesn't press the issue either. "Alright."

Adora doesn't look down at whatever the doctor is doing but she's not sure where she's supposed to be looking. She looks at the degrees on the wall, the cute pictures of babies and weird diagrams. She swears she doesn't mean to, but her eyes end up catching the screen the doctor is looking at.

It's so grainy and small. A tiny little thing, just *there*. She's been so worried about Catra, she's hardly worried about what carrying her pregnancy would mean. In a flash she can imagine it—a little kid, toddling along with Catra's chin and her curls. Someone who would carry little pieces of Catra in their looks and personality and in the values Catra raises them with.

She can't help but feel enamored with the idea. If Catra wants it, if she decides to be a mom, every part of Adora wants to bear witness to it. To love Catra like she always had and spread that

love to the grainy gray dot on the screen. It already feels like her heart is twice as big, as impossible as that sounds.

"What are you doing?"

Adora tries to school her expression as her friend eyes her with concern. "Nothing! I'm good." She picks up some random leaflet on the counter and pretends to be rivetted by HPV transmission prevention.

Adora doesn't look up when she hears Catra's question, but her stomach drops. "Can I see the ultrasound?"

She can't look up and gauge Catra's reaction—it feels like an intrusion. She wonders how she'll feel though. If she'll feel warm and love it or if she'll hate it for putting her under this stress. If the depression won't let her feel much of anything. Adora is scared to ask.

The doctor lays out all Catra's options with no judgment, making it clear she has a week to decide if she wants to terminate using the abortion pill. A week feels like no time at all for such a momentous decision but there's no controlling that. By the time the doctor is done, Catra looks exhausted.

She lays back and moves her feet out of the stirrups and pulls the light blue hospital gown so that it sits better on her frame. For the first time since the examination started, they make eye contact.
"What the fuck am I doing, Adora?"

"What do you mean?"

"Why am I even thinking twice about this!" She raises her arms so that they cover her face. "I'm no good for this."

Adora knows what she has to do—it's her job to comfort Catra and make sure she picks what's right for her. She violently shoves down and feeling or wishes that she might have about Catra's situation. They aren't relevant, anyway.

"Look, you're the only one who can answer this question. And I'm not trying to push you either way but know you will be alright regardless of your choice."

Her eyes hold disgust and it makes Adora almost take a step back. "Because I was so okay before I knocked myself up."

Catra's anger at herself ignites the same in Adora. "You're grieving. Stop shitting on yourself for having an emotion." She takes a careful breath, trying to reign in her emotions. "Sorry." She mutters out. "Look, I'll be honest. I'm really worried about you, Catra." She watches Catra making sure she's listening. "Ever since C'yra died, it's like a part of you left with her. And look I get that you haven't been at your best but you will find a way to cope. I know it. You've been my best friend since I was twelve years old, and I have yet to see you fail."

All she wants is for Catra to find herself again. To have peace of mind that she's okay. She has to believe that Catra will conquer every obstacle because Adora can't live with the alternative.

"You shouldn't have so much faith in me." It's a low, soft warning that hardly heeds Adora of anything.

"Too bad." There's no world where Adora doesn't believe in Catra.

Adora is confused when Catra arrives at their apartment, gingerly walking in with a pharmacy bag. At first, she wonders if she's sick but then she realizes—Catra's terminating. She'd thought she'd get more warning than Catra showing up, prepared to take the pills but she supposes it really isn't her business. She quickly thinks about trying to move her schedule around so she can be here—Adora read online that the effects of the pill can be painful. Catra will need her, even if she doesn't want to admit it.

Her hand twitches to her pocket so she can call work, but she's stopped by the nervous look Catra gives her. "I, um—I probably should have told you before but—I've decided to keep the baby."

She stutters out, her face timid as she waits for Adora’s reaction. She’s holding her hand to her stomach—wow.

"That's—that's great, Catra." It’s such a radical change from what she thought was going to happen Adora’s not sure the words sink in. She was almost sure Catra would choose to terminate she didn’t even let herself linger on the alternative.

Catra doesn’t seem happy with her, which only confuses Adora. "Did you—did you mean it when you said that I can still stay here with you?" The anxiousness clicks into place and slowly, the idea that Catra is going to stay pregnant—that she’s having a *baby*—sinks in too. "I'll need some time but I'm sure I can figure something out, I—hmph."

In her excitement, Adora almost slams into Catra, pulling her into a hug. “Sorry! Did that hurt the baby?" She runs a worried hand over the place where Catra’s baby resides.

Catra loosens up, a more relaxed smile crossing her face. "I don't think you can hurt them with a hug." She teases.

She feels all those warm feelings that she’d had at the doctor’s office with Catra swarm back now that she feels like she’s allowed to have them. She pulls Catra in for another hug reveling in how Catra holds her back.

"Of course, you can stay here Catra. This is your home and I want to be here for both of you." She pulls back enough so she can show Catra how happy she is. "You'd be doing me a favor, so I don't have to drive somewhere to pester you as much as I want."

"Remember that when there is a child screaming at three in the morning."

Adora rolls her eyes playfully. "Yes, mom."

"Ugh, how weird. That'll be me in a few months."

The thought is electric. She’s sure that she can imagine Catra as a mother far better than the woman can herself. It does bring into question who else would be a parent. "Are you planning on telling the other parent?" The few imaginings Adora had, she honestly hadn’t thought much of Catra’s co-parent.

"As fucking awful as it is to say—I'm not sure who it is." She shrugs. "I've narrowed it down to two people—one is a girl from out of state and the other was the bass player for an indie band I can't remember the name of that was in town."

It’s easier to push aside the jealousy this time. If Catra can have more support and her child can have a second parent that’s good for them, then that can only be a good thing. "You don't have any contacts for them?"

Catra looks away. "I was pretty messed up." It’s barely a whisper. "I don't remember their faces all that well."

Adora bites her lip before nodding. She can’t imagine how vulnerable that would be to admit. "Alright. Well, I think that if you don't know who they are then it kind of answers that question, right?" There’s no sense in Catra feeling guilty when she has no way of contacting whoever it might be. "If you find them, then you can think about it more."

"Yeah, that was kind of my thought."

She reaches for the bag Catra is holding, realizing they must be the prenatal vitamins the doctor mentioned. "Let's see how many of these you have to take." She tilts her head and considers Catra. "And when was the last time you ate? Are you hungry?"

Adora doesn’t want to be overbearing, but the baby will be a good excuse to make sure Catra starts eating regular meals again.

Adora’s unsure how it happened, but pregnancy seems to slowly pull Catra out of her grief. There are days when she can’t make it out of bed still, but a lot of her self-destructive tendencies have

mostly been curbed. Better than that, she'll quietly tell Adora when she needs space or needs to be held, or sometimes she'll just talk about C'yra and what she misses most about her.

Catra smiles more, even if it's not every day. But Adora hasn't heard her laugh like she's laughing today. Adora is on her knees in front of Catra, head leaning into her bump. She can feel the belly shaking from Catra's laugh as she eyes Adora fondly. She'd do anything to keep her smiling like this and it feels so good to be familiar again.

They'd slowly grown closer, not only physically but emotionally. Catra has dropped some of the walls she'd built around herself after C'yra's death and allowed Adora in again. It feels almost better than it did before—now Adora can fully appreciate how lucky she is when Catra confides in her. It also feels good to be allowed to dream with Catra about their baby.

She's keeping in her own laugh when she feels something different from the bump—a little pat from the inside, bumping her hand. She looks up to see if Catra felt it too, but Catra is already looking down, gauging Adora's reactions.

"They moved." She looks at Catra's belly with what can only be adoration. Adora can almost imagine the little one in there. "You're already so talented, aren't you?"

Adora loves this baby more than she ever thought she'd love anyone except for Catra. She can't wait to meet them.

Catra's hand grazes the side of Adora's head, and it makes her shiver. "Adora, they are supposed to be moving by now."

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"Well, you're the aunt they are living with, so you sure have an advantage."

"Damn right, I have the advantage." It’s an odd place to be. She’s painfully aware of the fact that this baby is just Catra’s—it doesn’t help Adora feel any less attached. She’s not sure that she’s able to hold back and she isn’t willing to try. "And I'm going to press it."

She makes faces so that Catra will laugh and keeps rubbing her belly for a little while longer. She wants to press a kiss there, but she worries that might be too much.

Adora isn’t sure how she got herself in this position, but she’s worried she’s crossed a line. Catra is in her third trimester, and nothing seems to comfort her—her feet hurt, she can’t sleep, and Finn is active. It’s a little weird—Adora can see Finn’s elbows and knees when they flip around, like they have half a mind to get out before their due date.

All of this has made Catra lean heavily on Adora for support and she can’t say she has minded. And she doesn’t mind now, but it’s hard to be a supportive best friend when Catra is topless and Adora is spooning her.

Her skin is so soft. Adora runs her hands under Catra’s rounded belly, pushing firmly enough that Catra lets out small groans of relief. Adora can smell Catra’s hair as she nuzzles her, legs touching, and bodies pressed close. She absolutely shouldn’t be doing this.

"Is this okay?" She doesn’t have to whisper but her voice comes out low anyway. Catra arches into her touch and Adora has to bite her lip and think about anything else.

"It's really nice."

Adora dims a little at that. Catra sounds breathless, but she’s heavily pregnant—she only runs on tired these days. She shakes

off her disappointment. That's exactly what she should be hoping for—that she can provide some comfort to her friend.

Adora creates a little bit of space between them so she can run her hands over the small of Catra's back. She gets her thumbs into the spots that hold the most tension.

"Fuck, Adora."

She blinks, stopping herself from clenching her thighs together at the exclamation. She keeps her mind singularly focused on being helpful and thinking of Catra's comfort and *nothing else*. She slowly works her hands up, rubbing all of Catra's back and pausing when she finds a knot.

"Is this good?" She checks in again. She doesn't want to do anything to make Catra uncomfortable. There's a slight nod that Adora feels more than sees—Catra keeps pushing back, giving Adora a counterweight to work with as she bears down on some of the tense spots.

She manages to make it all the way up Catra's back without incident, a full back massage that will hopefully leave her relaxed enough to sleep through the night. Adora has a moment of weakness—in the haze of touching Catra and holding her so close, she presses a kiss on her neck when she's done.

It's not exactly platonic and Adora has no explanation if Catra were to ask for one, but she doesn't. Catra seems just as relaxed—she doesn't even look back at Adora when she does it.

"I hope that feels helpful." Adora struggles to find her voice, but she gets there. "I know there can be a lot of pent-up stress during pregnancy. I was reading about it and I thought this could help." All of that is true, but it doesn't address the desire that burns through her. That she'll simply have to take to the grave.

Catra is quiet for a few moments too long, enough that Adora wonders if she's fallen asleep. "The massage felt really good. Thank you."

She feels her shoulders drop back in relief—Catra doesn't sound upset.

"I better head over to my bed." She doesn't want to go, but any more time is just asking for her to trip up and do something stupid.

She doesn't look down at Catra until she's managed to untangle herself from the sheets and safely outside of her bed. Catra bites her lips and looks Adora over. She's not sure what she's looking for but she seems fine, so Adora shrugs it off.

She leans down and places a tender kiss on her forehead, and then presses her cheek to Catra's belly. Adora closes her eyes briefly and smiles when she feels Finn moving.

"Good night, you two."

Adora doesn't stop walking until she's safely in the bathroom, where she proceeds to take a very cold shower. It's not much help.

"Can I count on you to make it to dinner this Sunday?"

Adora sighs, holding the phone between her shoulder and ear as she glances down the grocery aisle. "I can't, mom." She says absentmindedly, trying to remember which brand of cracker are the ones that Catra prefers now. She's switched at least four times during her pregnancy and keeping it all straight is driving Adora crazy. "Catra is going to go into labor any day now and it's too far from the hospital."

She doesn't want to be caught anywhere farther than forty-five minutes from the hospital if she can help it. She and Catra had practiced breathing exercises and she had packed their go bag. She wants to leave as little to possible to chance.

"You're going to be there when Finn's born?"

"Yeah. Catra asked me." She didn't really. They'd just started planning it that way as if it was a foregone conclusion. To Adora it was—if Catra wanted her there, then there was no place Adora would rather be than supporting her as she delivered Finn into the world.

She hears her mother sigh on the phone. "Have you *really* talked about Finn?"

Adora stops looking at crackers and grabs the phone with her hand, the other on the grocery cart. "Yeah? We talk about Finn all the time." They sometimes talk about other things of course, but with their birth right around the corner, Finn is a big topic of discussion.

"I can't tell if you're being oblivious on purpose or not." Her mother sounds impatient, which is rare for her—at least when it comes to Finn. Throughout Catra's pregnancy she's been beyond supportive, helping Adora with the baby shower and giving Catra a someone to confide who had been pregnant before.

"I'm not."

"Okay. You and Catra are living together. You've been to all her doctor's appointments, and you hang the sonograms in your office. You're going to be there when she gives birth." Adora has a sinking feeling her mother is counting these off on her fingers. "So, I'm asking—who is Finn to you?"

Adora swallows, her mouth dry. The answer she wants to give—that Finn is *hers* that she belongs to them and she'd to *anything* for them—is the wrong one. "I'm—Finn's is Catra's baby. I'll be like their aunt. You know that."

Marlena blows air through her teeth. "Does Catra know your in love with her?"

"Mom!" She feels her cheek burn. "I'm not—it isn't—"

“Adora, you can lie to me if you like, but please don’t lie to yourself.” It’s a stern tone Adora knows very well. The kind that meant her mom was not messing around and she planned to impart a lesson. “I don’t want to see you or Catra getting hurt. And I especially don’t want Finn, an innocent child, stripped of your love because of a misunderstanding between you and Catra. Please be careful.”

“There’s nothing to be careful about.” Adora sets her jaw. “It’s true that I love Catra, but that’s okay. Catra doesn’t feel the same way, but she would never keep Finn from me. We’ve always been best friends and that isn’t changing anytime soon.”

“I know that. I just worry that if you love Finn as a child—as *your* child—there’s no coming back from that. And if Catra gets a partner and you haven’t defined the place you have in Finn’s life __”

“We’ll cross that bridge when we get to it.” Adora interrupts. She can’t believe she’s having this conversation in a grocery store. She knows that her mother means well—that she doesn’t want to see Adora heart broken because she’s too invested in a child that isn’t hers. The truth is, Adora never had a real choice. “I’m going to love Finn in whatever way feels natural to me. I know I’m not Finn’s mother, but I’ll never regret being there for Finn and Catra.”

“I know that sweetie. I love Catra and little Finn, I don’t want you to doubt that. I just love you too.”

Adora nods even though her mom can’t see her. “I know. Everything is under control. I’ll let you know when Catra has the baby.”

“Please, as if I’m not going to show up at the hospital.”

Adora laughs like it’s a joke because she’s kind of hoping it is one. “I love you. Mom. I have to go.”

“Wait one more thing.”

Adora moves past the crackers. She'll circle back. "Yes?"

"You think I wouldn't realize you named Finn?"

She grimaces and bites her lip. It was a little too much to hope for—she knew her mother would immediately figure it out, but she was hoping to not get called out on it. "It isn't a secret." She offers back evenly.

She's braced for some scathing comment—Marlena is a wonderful mom but she's unafraid to drag her children—but she's not prepared for her mother's next words.

"Your grandfather would have loved it." Marlena sounds almost tender and Adora can swear she's smiling.

She unreasonably feels a knot building in her throat. "Thanks. I thought he might." She'd always been close to her grandfather, and although he'd been named William, he'd confided in Adora he wished for a long time his name was Finn. Not many people knew that, but Marlena did.

"Thanks." She manages to get out before blowing out air through her nose. "Gotta go. Bye."

Adora keeps making her way through her grocery list, refusing to think about that conversation until late at night when it keeps her from sleep.

Adora is severely, desperately, underprepared for Finn's birth. She'd fastidiously read all the articles and books, went to all the courses with Catra, all the doctor's appointments. Up to this very moment, she thought she'd been doing a great job at keeping it together.

She held Catra's hand and reminded her of her breathing. She'd promised Catra she would stay when she begged for Adora—a promise hardly worth making because there wasn't a single force that could tear her from Catra's side. She'd kept her cool and

encouraged Catra until the very end. How could she not? Catra had done amazing. If anything, it made her fall that much more in love with her.

No, the actual delivery went perfect, thankfully. But no one prepared Adora for the moment she saw Finn, covered in blood and who knows what else, lying on Catra's chest. She'd thought about Finn so much before they were born—but they were *here*. Finn is alive and screaming their little lungs off and Catra is a mother.

She's looking down at them so tenderly, her hands somehow knowing exactly how to hold them even though she'd panicked about it multiple times before today. Catra is already different and in that moment so is Adora. She always knew that Finn would mean so much to her, but this is something else entirely.

"Why are you crying?" Catra looks concerned after handing Finn over to a nurse so she can clean them up.

Adora touches her wet cheek—she hadn't realized she'd been crying. "I just—Catra you're a mom! And they are so beautiful. I'm so happy." It's a violent type of joy—as if the sun is so bright all you can see is white. She kisses Catra's forehead, pulling back so she can look at her face. "You're amazing. I'm so proud of you."

Adora is in absolute awe of her. She can't believe Catra's strength—not only physically but emotionally. The way that Catra managed to make it through the last year only stands to make Adora surer that Catra is one of the most amazing women she's ever known.

"I guess I'm alright." Catra's lips wobble and her eyes shine, but she stays smiling.

The nurse returns with Finn bundled up and Adora starts crying again. She wipes the tears quickly so she can keep looking at them. Their little face is scrunched up and they have a little hat. Adora can't even fathom that they make hats that small. The

nurse is leaning over to give the baby to Catra but she turns to look at her.

"Adora, can you carry them?"

She looks down at Finn, her heart thudding in her chest. "Are you sure?"

"Yeah, of course. Favorite aunt, right?"

She nods, although the reminder kind of makes her want to die a little. The nurse hands them over and they're so small.

"Wow." They barely weigh like anything nestled in her arms. She feels like she could hold them forever and it wouldn't be long enough. "You're so handsome, bud. Absolutely beautiful."

"Adora, stop lying to the baby." Catra is grinning and Adora can't help but grin back.

"No, I'm not! They have your nose." They look a little red and swollen, but they were just born so Adora can hardly hold that against them. Besides, she'd know Catra's nose anywhere. She swears she can feel them nuzzle into her arms a little before their face clears, eyes fluttering shut. "Finn, I love you so much. And your mama loves you. And there are at least fifteen people in that hospital waiting room that are going to spoil you rotten."

"Fifteen?"

Adora glances over at Catra's panicked face. "Don't worry, I'm going to snap some pictures to show the crowd and get them out of here. They can come to visit once you think it's a good idea." She's not surprised that her friends and family are there to show their support. She imagines they just want Catra to know that she and Finn are important to them, and Adora can hardly fault them for that. She looks down at Finn again, swaying a little as she holds them. "You're going to be so loved. You're going to have more family than you can imagine. I promise you that."

She looks up when she hears Catra crying for the first time since she gave birth. When she looks up at Catra she gives her a small smile before wiping at her tears. "I wish my mom were here."

Adora feels her heart pang. She can't imagine how much Catra is missing her mom right now. "I know. C'yra would have beat me in an arm wrestling contest to be in the room with you today."

Catra lets out a wet chortle. "Oh my God, you two would do that. She always loved you."

"Wherever she is Catra, I have to believe she isn't missing out on this." She knows that if C'yra has any choice in the matter, she's watching over Catra and Finn now too. Adora gives her the best comfort she knows how—she hands over Finn to Catra. "I know there's nothing for missing her, but you both are going to be okay."

"Sorry to interrupt family time, but I want to make sure the little one is latching appropriately." The nurse has an apologetic smile as she glances between Catra and Adora.

She nods at the nurse. "Give me a minute." She quickly pulls out a phone and takes a few pictures of Catra and Finn. Finn looks kind of grumpy and Catra looks… beautiful, like always. Tired and half asleep, but gorgeous. She's going to have to convince Catra not let her print some of these for their apartment, even if it isn't somewhere as visible as the living room. "I'm going to show everyone pictures and get them out of the waiting room. You'll be alright alone for a minute?"

"We'll be okay." She gives Adora a reassuring smile and a nod.

The moment she makes it out to the bright sterile lights of the hallway, Adora feels lost. Her hand is on the door still and she contemplates going back, which is kind of pathetic. She walks a few paces before she stops, coming face to face with a vending machine that she's sure is here almost exclusively for long delivery nights.

Her feet won't move anymore, and her chest feels tight. Too tight. She tries to take a deep breath, but it's hard. She leans over on the wall, taking a few breathes as she calms her heart. Adora starts crying suddenly, and she doesn't understand why—almost like the feelings hits her before the thought does.

Fuck, Finn isn't her kid. How can she love them *this* much if they aren't? What's she supposed to do with this crushing feeling in her chest, the way she suddenly feels like she became a mother, but *it's not true*. How will she be able to explain to anyone what's happened to her?

She's sobbing loud enough that she's worried a concerned nurse might make her way over, so she wipes at her face and tries to calm down. She knew this was a possibility—likely, even. Adora wasn't prepared because she couldn't have dimensioned feelings like this. They were outside of her frame of experience and now, there was nothing that could fix it. She knew with certainty that her heart was lost to Finn forever, regardless of whatever comes next.

Adora manages to find a nearby bathroom and tosses water on her face. It takes her a good fifteen minutes before she's ready to meet everyone in the waiting room. It's a little easier to bear there—everyone is so joyful, cooing over the pictures of Finn and asking Adora to pass along well wishes.

The only moment that she feels that sadness creeping in again is a quiet one with her mother.

Marlena seems to see through her. She's as happy as everyone else, but she gives Adora a more somber smile. "How are you holding up?" It sounds knowing and it pulls at Adora's quivering heart.

"They're absolutely beautiful, mom. Everything I could have hoped for."

Marlena looks at her for a long moment before pulling her into a tight hug. "I look forward to meeting my grandchild then. When Catra's comfortable." It's a whisper in Adora's ear that Adora understands for what it is. Acceptance of how Adora feels about Finn.

She nods, getting teary eyed again. "I'm excited for you to meet them too."

She stays a little longer, but the more time she spends away the more she wishes she were back in the hospital room with Catra and Finn. Her dad laughs when he sees her look toward the elevator a third time in as many minutes, probably guessing exactly where her head is at.

"Well, I think it's time for us all to go." Even though he isn't yelling, his voice carries over everyone whose there for Finn. He looks at Adora and gives her a hug. "Send Catra and the baby all our love. Make sure you take care of them."

There's something serious in his eyes that makes her nod feel like a promise. "I will."

After a few more goodbyes and an offer from Glimmer to buy her and Catra some food so they can have something better than the hospital fare, Adora makes her way back the same hallway. She pauses at the door for a moment. It doesn't take much for her to pull on a bright smile—no matter what, she prefers to be here, with Catra and Finn, than anywhere else in the world.

Adora used to sleep like the dead, but ever since they brought Finn home it's like she hardly falls asleep at all. Well, that is true—between waking up to change Finn and making sure Catra isn't running herself ragged, Adora hasn't been sleeping all that much. But it's more than that. Whenever she does fall asleep, it's almost with a mind of when she's next waking up—her body doesn't truly relax.

It's how she ends up hearing Finn’s quiet coos from across the apartment. She carefully pads into Catra’s room, making her way to the crib she’d set up in the corner. Finn is still bundled up, making soft little sounds to let everyone know they’re up. When she comes into view, they make a delighted sound, blue eyes opening wider.

“Shhh, little bear.” Adora whispers before grabbing them. She holds them to her chest, knowing exactly what they’re after. It’s been a few weeks but she and Catra have figured out a lot in that time.

Adora turns and looks over at Catra, lightly snoring in her bed. Given that Finn is mostly breastfeeding, there’s only so much that Adora can do to lessen the load on Catra. Not only is she having to wake up every few hours to feed Finn, but her body is also still recovering from giving birth and constantly producing milk. Adora is always awestruck by how she manages.

She knows Finn doesn’t have to be fed for another hour, but she also knows that if she tries to put them back into their crib, they’ll keep making little noises or crying until someone gets them. Maybe she can sway them to sleep until Catra has to wake up later to feed them.

She bounces them gently, but their big blue eyes stay stubbornly open. Adora doesn’t even feel mad, all she feels is warm. “I love you so much.” She whispers it in their hair before placing a soft kiss atop their head.

Finn is just so good. They could be up all night and Adora would still think they’re perfect, but even when they are, they’re in such a great mood. All their little noises are adorable, and if it wasn’t the middle of the night Adora might be tempted to try and play with them even though they are still too small to understand.

She hums, letting the noise stay in her chest as she holds them there, hoping maybe that will help. They don’t fall asleep, but they do seem to be soothed, their blinks slower and eyes hooded.

Adora swallows thickly, just looking down at them. Her little Finnie. Not hers in all the ways they could be, but definitely in all the ways that matter. She couldn’t love them more if she’d birthed them herself—she’s certain of it.

"What are you doing up?" Adora looks over in time to see Catra stretch and lets out a short yawn before padding over to her. It’s not fair that Catra sounds so sexy having just woken up. Especially now that sleepy seems to be the new normal.

Adora turns to her to give her a smile. "Finn and I are hanging out so you can get some sleep."

Catra rolls her eyes but smiles. "You forgot that I'm the milk provider."

"I didn't—we've been hanging out for an hour. Which is one hour more of sleep than you would have gotten otherwise."

"Shit." Catra’s seems really upset by it, even though it isn’t anything new or different from what they’ve been doing since they brought Finn home.

She makes sure to grip Finn tightly to her chest before reaching out with the other hand to comfort Catra. "Hey, it's okay."

It seems Catra won’t be soothed. "No, but—I need to be able to do this."

Adora furrows her brow. "Catra. You are doing this." She’s doing an amazing job at motherhood and Adora is honestly confused by whatever it is that Catra’s feeling.

She lets out a soft sad noise. "But you're helping."

Helping. Adora’s brows knit harder together, this time in frustration. "So? You think moms don't deserve help?"

"No that's not it. It's just, what if we need to do it on our own?"

Adora moves her hand back onto Finn, carefully holding them with two hands again. She’s certain that whatever this is, isn’t about Adora, but it still hurts. "Catra. In what scenario are you and Finn not going to have someone to count on?"

That someone is obviously Adora, if no one else. At least, she’d like to think that Catra knows she has Adora’s unconditional support.

Catra holds her hands up helplessly, her face apologetic. "I don't know. But it scares me to think I can't do it on my own if I had to."

Adora bites her lip and considers Catra—really thinks about everything she’s gone through. "Look, I know losing your mom was unexpected. But you aren't going to lose everyone else, okay?" She can’t help but get closer until she’s hugging Catra. "You won't lose me." She whispers into her shoulder.

Adora isn’t sure if that’s it, but the way Catra holds her tightly makes her feel like it is. That’s fine. It’s okay for Catra to feel scared sometimes—Adora is going to show her she has nothing to worry about. With time and patience, Catra will come to see that there’s nothing Adora won’t do for Finn. And there’s no way she’d ever leave Catra and Finn if she could help it.

Finn makes another little noise, this time a disgruntled one. Adora pulls back so that they aren’t crowded between her and Catra, swaying them slightly. "Ready to feed them, mama?"

Sometimes, when Catra looks at her like that, it feels like she knows how Adora feels. Like she can see the raw feelings in her chest. For a split second, she expects Catra to demand answers, to ask her exactly what it is that keeps Adora besotted to Catra and her baby. She doesn’t ask a thing, instead nodding softly and opening her arms.

"Yeah. Give them over." Adora does as Catra asks and she keeps Catra company while she nurses Finn, even though the smart

thing would be to go back to sleep before Finn wakes up again.

Catra can make fun of her all she wants, but getting this baby carrier is the best thing that's ever happened to her back. Finn is starting to get heavier as they grow and with the carrier, Adora feels like she can take care of them all day. She also is excited for this—she can't believe Finn's first real outing is here to her childhood home.

Sunday dinner at her parents' home is a thread that has been a constant in her life. She doesn't make it every Sunday, but it happens often enough that she has plenty of feelings of nostalgia around it. She always imagine a child of hers would one day run around as they got ready to eat, and this is already better than anything she's ever imagined.

For a long while, Finn snoozes in the carrier and Adora is free to socialize and actually have use of her arms. The moment Finn appears to wake, Marlena is right there next to her. "Now can I carry them?"

Adora lets out a huffed laugh. "You're worse than a toddler." She scolds playfully before starting to undo the buckles that keep the carrier together.

Finn lets out a little grunt at first, displeased by all of the shifting, but it doesn't last all that long. They let out a coo as Adora hands them over to her mom. They cur into her, right as rain.

"Oh, Finnie," Marlena runs a hand over their back. "You're my favorite grandchild." She places a loud kiss on their cheek.

Adora kind of hopes that will fly under the radar but there's no chance of that when she realizes that Adam was overhearing their mother. "Aw come on, mom! Let my kids have a chance!"

She glances over nervously at Catra, who is sitting next to Adam. Catra looks at the volley with interest, but she doesn't seem offended.

"You don't have any kids, Adam."

"Yet!"

Marlena rolls her eyes. "Well, obviously if I had more than one grandchild, I'd be fair." She looks down at Finn. "But for now, Finn is the favorite." She goes right back to babying Finn, whispering about this or that while they soak up all the attention.

Randor looks at Marlena, skeptical. "I get the feeling Finn will always be your favorite."

"I'm feeling very attacked by this family," Marlena states with a huff, pulling Finn close. "Finn and I are going to look at the birds from the porch." She takes Finn there and Adora is left floundering at the edges of the social activity.

She makes a beeline to Catra. Her mom calling Finn her grandchild feels like too much—like something that leaves Adora and her feelings exposed and in the open for anyone to examine. "I'm sorry about my mom, she really loves Finn. I hope it doesn't make you feel weird—"

Catra smiles and holds her hand up, stopping Adora. "It's the only way Finn gets grandparents. I'm thrilled that Marlena and Randor are having a good time practicing."

Adora feels her heart sink in her chest. "Finn isn't practice." The thought alone feels horrifying—to narrow down everything Finn means to her and to the rest of her family like that. "Finn is always going to be a part of this family, as long as you'd like that."

Catra puts a comforting hand on Adora’s shoulder squeezing it. "Of course, I want Finn to be an honorary Grayskull." She raises an eyebrow. "They need to grow in their teeth so they can have Sunday dinner."

Adora feels a swell of relief fill her. It’s not exactly what she wants but it’s a new way that she can give Finn more of herself and her

family. "I'm really glad."

Catra smiles as if it’s an easy give. She probably has no idea what it means to Adora.

She’d love it if she had friends who were less nosy. It would make Adora’s life that much simpler if she didn’t have to worry about Glimmer sticking her nose where it didn’t belong. It always started with wanting what was best for Adora and ended in her giving her a recommendation that sounds like the worst idea ever.

She knows it’s not strictly true—Glimmer had a few points that made sense. A lot of her concerns were the same ones that Marlena had raised before Catra gave birth—that Adora was too deep and too far gone for Catra and Finn for her relationship with Catra to stay platonic. That she needed to maybe do something about that. Something that didn’t include doubling or tripling down.

Except, Glimmer thought that the solution of all things, was to go clubbing. As if clubbing had ever fixed any of Adora’s problems—or Glimmer’s for that matter. Besides, Adora doesn’t have a problem. Her situation might be unconventional, but she isn’t unhappy. If anything, she’s happier than she’s ever been.

The thing that kept circling in her mind that Glimmer said, is that she thinks Adora’s love for Catra is requited—that Catra obviously felt the same way. Where had Glimmer gotten that idea from? The thought made her palms sweat and her heart beat loudly, but it didn’t seem possible. Catra would have said something by now.

Glimmer invited her clubbing tonight—or rather, threatened to come disturb the peace and drag Adora out if she refused to come. She’s sure Glimmer means well, but Adora hates the idea.

She’s viciously scrubbing one of Finn’s bottles when Catra passes by her, mild worry on her face. "What's got you so down?"

"It's nothing."

"Adora." She says warningly. How she sounds like such a mom when Finn is just in diapers is beyond Adora.

She crosses her arms over her chest. "Glimmer wants me to go out tonight."

"Okay. What's the problem, then?" Catra shrugs.

She shoots Catra a look. "I don't know if you know this Catra, but we have a baby in this apartment."

"So? Adora you can still live your life. Finn is my responsibility." Catra reaches a hand out, touching Adora's shoulder. "I appreciate the help, really. But you can absolutely go out with Glimmer. Just be quiet when you come in."

She shrugs off Catra's hand and swallows thickly. They have routines and shared chores and a life together, but all anyone seems to see it as is help. Except for Adora. "Alright. I'll tell her that I can go."

She goes off into her room, putting on whatever is simpliest. She barely looks at what she's picking, just enough to know she won't look like a fool. It's been a long time since she want out but she's not putting in that much effort. It doesn't take all that long for her to get ready and send Glimmer a short text message letting her know she'll meet her at the club.

She peeks into Catra's room and finds her holding Finn. She feels some satisfaction when Catra notices her, eyes trailing down Adora before snapping back up to her eyes.

"You look fantastic, Adora."

She feels herself soften some. "Thanks. A dress seemed like the easiest thing." She gets closer, placing a hand on Finn's torso. They perk up leaning into the touch. "Hey, bud. I'm going to be out for a few hours because aunt Glimmer is mean." She whispers conspiratorially.

Finn gives her plenty of attention, clearly wanting her to carry them. She can’t help but look at Catra. "See? Finn wants me to stay."

If it’s clear enough to Finn, who’s only a few months old, that Adora should stay why can’t it be obvious to everyone else that this is where she belongs? She hates how she feels, looking at Catra and hoping that she’ll want her enough to ask her to stay.

Catra balances Finn on her hips, lips pursed as she eyes Adora. "Well, mama understands that aunt Adora needs a break and to live her own life sometimes. And that aunt Glimmer just wants her to have a good time."

"Sure, sure." She gives Finn a soft kiss and takes a step back. "I'll see you both soon."

The night out with Glimmer is mostly a flop. She has two drinks and then she gets misty eyed thinking about how much she wishes that she were home. That some things would be different. Glimmer quickly realized that the most she was going to get out of her was some half-hearted dancing and a few moody drinks. At least she was gracious about it, only telling Adora that she should make a move so that she could have the family she’s been building for herself. Adora is pretty sure that’s not in the cards.

Her feet hurt like crazy when she finally makes it back home. She can’t remember the last time she wore heels for longer than an hour or two—Adora definitely hadn’t missed it. She manages to get the door open quietly and gets her shoes off so she doesn’t wake Finn if their sleeping.

She’s struck but the smell of her apartment—it smells like home. When did that happen? Adora smiles a little at the thought of it. She doesn’t have time to wonder if both mother and child are sleeping or awake before she catches sight of her roommate.

Catra is standing in the kitchen, wearing one of Adora’s old college shirts—the baggy kind she’d always steal, but particularly took to

during her pregnancy. She’s tired but she looks relaxed as she pads over softly to Adora. "How was it?"

The honest truth bursts out of her. "Fucking awful. I wish I was home with you and Finn." Like a magnet, she finds her feet carrying her into Catra’s room until she can spot the tufts of blonde hair in the crib in the corner. Sometimes Finn reminds her of a little duck—soft and downy, fragile and small. Adora would do anything to protect them.

She feels Catra come to stand next to her, also overlooking Finn. "Come on, it couldn’t have been that bad."

"It wasn't, I just—" She can’t say what she really wants—there’s no point in dragging her feelings into this. She decides to stick with something Catra already knows. "You know I'm not one for going out." She watches Catra nod her head, as if agreeing. "And I missed you. And Finn." Miss isn’t even half of it. It felt empty, going out and pretending that she didn’t want to be right where she is now. "I guess, I've gotten used to having you two around a lot."

Catra’s weight shifts next to her, and she turns to look at Adora. "Well, it's normal for you to do things like that. You can't let us stop you from having a life."

She knows that Catra doesn’t mean it like that, but it feels like she’s crushing Adora’s heart in her hands. A reminder that as much as Adora might think of her and Catra and Finn as one unit, it doesn’t mean Catra does. It doesn’t mean Catra wants her at all.

"Now you sound like Glimmer."

She can tell it was a mistake the moment the words leave her mouth because Catra freezes, eyes wide with an edge of panic to them. Fuck. "Glimmer said that?"

"She did, but not in like a mean way or anything. She's just worried." Fuck, that’s not much better. Adora doesn’t want to have

to muddle through this conversation now—really, ever but even pushing it to tomorrow feels like a better option. "Look, Catra. It's after midnight and Finn needs to be up for a bottle at two unless they wake up even earlier than that. Let's just sleep for now?"

"No. One of your closest friends thinks that we're hurting you." She’s set in her stance and her arms crosses over her chest in a way that Adora knows means there’s no way out of this but through it.

"It's not—neither of you get it." No one does. Throughout Catra’s pregnancy she’s gotten used to confused looks about how she fits into everything—mostly because she doesn’t have a place. No one understands that Adora would rather have some part in Finn and Catra’s life than something more with anyone else. "If I promise everything is fine, can we just go to sleep?" It’s a last-ditch effort and it fails miserably. Catra quirks one brow and waits. "Fine. Let's talk in my room so we don't bother the baby." She leads Catra over to her room, turning to look at Catra. "What do you want to know?"

Catra starts shifting her weight from side to side. She would almost look like she’s rocking Finn if the movements weren’t so fast. "Why is Glimmer concerned?"

"She thinks I dedicate too much time to you and Finn. She says it's fine for me to *help* but I can't be how I've been." Help. As if Adora’s role in their lives could be reduced to a babysitter or a nanny. She supposes what hurts the most is, there’s no discernable reason why that isn’t true—it means so much more to Adora than she has any right to.

Catra looks at her and a long moment of silence stretches between them. There’s a number of things Adora wishes Catra would say. That Glimmer is being ridiculous, that she wants Adora around. That she loves her.

Of course, that’s not at all what Catra says. "She’s probably right.” Catra ends up mumbling instead, and Adora has to bite her lip to

keep from crying. “It’s fine now, but what about when you want your own family?"

That throws her for a loop. What does Catra think, that Adora is biding her time, waiting for Catra to move out with Finn? That they’re expendable to her? "This is my family."

Catra gives her an indecipherable look. "I know Finn and I will always be your family, but you know what I mean, Adora."

Adora looks at Catra more, at the way her eyes glance off toward the door and she presses her lips into a tight line. She feels her heart clench in her chest. Maybe Catra thinks of this as some temporary, broken arrangement. Something that’s good enough for now, but not forever. Even when it’s everything Adora’s wanted.

"You and Glimmer are focused on the wrong things." It makes her a little angry, how both of them want to dictate what she should want for herself. She’s capable of knowing that on her own, and *she does*. "Because as much as there might be a world out there, it can't hold a candle to what I have here."

A ragged breath leaves her lungs. Suddenly, Adora feels so tired. So tired of pretending and letting what everyone else thinks she should want, what’s traditional, dictate how she acts.

"Catra, I don't want another family. I have my family right here." Catra’s face softens but Adora can tell she doesn't get what Adora means—she doesn’t understand how much Adora feels. “I love you. And I love Finn."

She blinks up at her, genuine shock on her face. "You mean—like you want Finn to be yours?"

She almost wants to laugh at that. It’s such a silly question—the gnawing want has only been the underpinning of every day of Adora’s life since she found out Catra was pregnant. "Of course, I want Finn to be mine." Catra still looks shocked and Adora wonders if maybe she hasn’t been as transparent as she thought.

“I—you have no idea how often I've sat awake at night thinking about it. About how much I wish that I could have you the way I want you, Catra." Adora is afraid she’s burning down the balance they’ve found, but she can’t help but wish things were different. "About how I think not only about Finn being mine but about being yours. About belonging to each other."

A family in every sense of the word, not just some of them.

Catra looks like she could be knocked over with a feather. Adora can’t tell if that’s a good thing or not. "You—really?"

"Yeah." There’s no point in holding any of it back anymore. “I snuck a look at the ultrasound." She confesses. "That first day when you weren't sure about keeping them. And it felt like my heart wasn't mine anymore. And it's so stupid because I know we aren't together—but right then and there, I swore that if you wanted to keep this kid, I'd do anything to be here with you two."

She knows where she stands, has known ever since she saw that little gray dot on the monitor. And really, she knew before that—has known ever since she realized that there was a part of her no other woman but Catra could touch.

"Adora, that's a lot."

Adora feels her gut drop. The doesn’t sound too promising.

"I know." She feels a knot building in her throat. "But it's true. And even if you don't feel the way I do. If you don't love me—" She can barely choke the words out as she takes a step closer. "I'll still be here. For you and for Finn."

As much as she wants to express the love she has for Catra and Finn differently, she doesn’t want to lose what they already have. She can shove her love down so that it’s small and quiet enough—so that it’s palatable. She can pass off the devotion she feels as the love of a friend or an aunt, if it means that she can stay. That she can make sure Finn and Catra are supported and taken care

of and that she gets to be a part of that. It’s what she’s been doing so far anyway.

Catra is clutching Adora’s arm tightly, her eyes shifting quickly over Adora’s face. "Fuck me." She curses out. "I love you too."

"Really?" Adora is holding Catra now, she doesn’t know how it happened. "You don't have to, I—"

She’s quieted by Catra’s closeness, her face inches away from Adora’s and her finger pressed to Adora’s mouth. "No buts. I had the biggest crush on you since sixth grade. And I've been in love with you since sophomore year."

"What?" She’d never seriously considered that Catra might feel the same way she did.

Catra smiles, not straying any farther. "Yeah."

The relief she feels is instantaneous, and it reminds her of something else. "Fuck, Glimmer was right."

"Right about what?"

"Well, the full lecture I got from her is that I should confess because she thinks you feel the same way I do. And that if I'm not willing to put up, I need to go out and have a more balanced life."

Catra snorts. "I can't believe she picked up on that."

"She's going to be insufferable." Adora can’t even bother to dim her smile at the prospect. "But I don't really care as long as I get to have you." She hopes she’s reading this right. Adora can feel her blood rushing in her ears as she closes the few inches of distance and for the first time—*finally*—she kisses Catra. It’s better than any of the times she’d imagined it. Catra’ groans into the kiss, her hands flying up into Adora’s hair. "Please let me touch you." She’s pressing Catra into her bedroom wall, letting her hands reach down Catra’s waist and lower.

Catra inhales sharply. "Are you sure? I'm not—I don't look the way I did before I gave birth."

There's a vulnerability in her voice that makes Adora pull back, although she doesn't stop touching Catra. "Are you kidding me?" She demands to know. Adora has always been attracted to Catra and the last few months have been torture in terms of her containing her desires. "Catra you can't imagine—I mean do you know how big your boobs are right now?"

Catra lets out a deep belly laugh that makes Adora somehow smile harder. "Yeah, but so is the rest of me."

"I don't know what I need to do to convince you but it's hot. So hot. All of it." It's unbelievable how watching Catra grow as a mom and a person somehow warms Adora but also lights a very different fire inside her. "And not in like, a fetish way. Just in a normal, 'I'm in love with you' way."

"Oh, you don't have a mommy kink." Catra's voice drops low and smirk crosses her face. Adora can feel the heat rushing to her face and watches in horror as Catra's eyes widen with surprise before shooting her a knowing look. "I'm filing that away for future use."

Adora hides her face in Catra's neck. "As long as you believe that I've been attracted to you since I knew what being gay was."

She lets her hands linger over Catra's frame before pulling her hand under the edge of that large shirt. Adora's reminded again that Catra's wearing her shirt, and she's about to take it off in her room and she might tug with a little more enthusiasm than she needs to. Catra giggles, helping Adora where the shirt is stuck, but as it's half over her, Finn lets out a loud wail.

She would think she'd been annoyed about being interrupted, but honestly missed Finn even in the few hours she was out.

"Duty calls." She drops a soft kiss on Catra's lips, just to make sure she didn't dream up the last few moments in her head.

She’s about to walk out when Catra tugs her back, her hand coming up to touch Adora’s face. "I love you."

Her heart clenches again and even though it hurts, Adora decides this feels so much better than before. She turns and realizes she’s still in her dress, she tugs it off. Adora hardly realizes she’s changing in front of Catra until she hears her behind her.

"I'm so gay."

Adora lets out a chuckle and tosses on a shirt she uses for sleeping. "I'm just done with the dress." She wants to be comfortable, and she doesn’t know if she’ll be able to bear leaving for long enough to change once they go back to Catra’s room.

Finn is still letting out some soft cries until they see Catra and Adora. They teeter in the crib, wanting to hold their hands out but needed to hold the rails for balance.

Catra looks amused. "You hungry, kid?" She laughs as they chew on their own hand, a definite yes. "Figures."

Catra gets comfortable, propping up Finn and lifting up her shirt. She looks up at Adora once Finn is settled and nursing.

Adora just sits there, the gravity of what’s happened between them not even beginning to sink in. She grins widely. "I feel like I'm going to wake up and I'll be dreaming."

"I never—I never thought you'd want me this way," Catra looks at her shyly.

That seems laughable—Adora doesn’t know that there was a time when she didn’t love Catra. When she didn’t wish that she could turn her head and get her to notice Adora as more than a best friend. She leans down and places a soft kiss on Catra’s lips, marveling that she gets to do that.

"I've always wanted you this way." It’s bene so long, Adora hardly remembers what it feels like to not belong to Catra. "From before

Finn. I know a lot of our lives have been caught up in them but I need you to know I love you for you. You're my best friend, Catra."

"I thought I got demoted." There's humor in her eyes but Adora doesn't want to make light of this.

"I love Finn to the moon and back, but there's no replacing what you mean to me." They are different loves, it's as simple as that. Catra is the person she loves and wants to be her partner in all things. She loves Finn like they're a part of her very heart. She looks at them and realizes they feel asleep. "God, when they sleep like that you can hardly believe that they can stay up all fucking night and be a little terror."

Catra lets out a short laugh. "Right?"

It doesn't take much for her and Catra to settle Finn down. Then Catra pulls Adora's hand, tangling their fingers together before crawling into bed. Adora holds Catra close, much like she used to when Catra was cranky and sore and needed affection but wasn't quite sure how to ask for it. Also, likely countless times when they were in school—but this didn't feel like that.

Adora's heart is pounding in her throat, and she doesn't think she'll get a wink of sleep no matter what she does. Her cheeks hurt from smiling, holding hands with Catra and looking her in the eyes.

To her utter delight, Catra turns red shying away from her stare. "You're being weird."

That does nothing to discourage Adora. If anything, it makes her smile harder and pull Catra closer. "Well, you like me so."

"And what of it?" It's such a Catra response it makes Adora let out a soft giggle.

She leans forward and kisses Catra again, this time slowly. She wants to learn how to kiss Catra every which way. There's no

words for how much it means to Adora, to have Catra feel the same way and she’s not going to try and butcher it at this time of night.

Instead, she shrugs. “Nothing. Is nice." She holds Catra close, comforted by the smell of her skin and her hair. She’s warm and Adora is surprised to find that she can find it in herself to be tired. "Now can we sleep for a bit before Finn decides that it's morning time?"

"Yeah. Love you." She feels Catra sigh into her neck and Adora pulls her in tighter.

"I love you too."

End Notes

Basically I reread Searching for Dandelion Wine and I was struck with all of my own HC about how sad Adora is about not being Finn's mom and I made myself cry so I wrote about it in hopes of making everyone else cry about it too.

How I basically removed scenes and this ended up being longer than the original is anyone's guess. The math does not math. Funnily enough I also wrote this one in one day like the first one and I am also very tired. Some things never change I guess lol.

I'd love to know what y'all thought of this :)

Kudos and comments make the keyboard go click clack. You can find me on Twitter, Bluesky, and Tumblr.

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